



Claim Process & Reimbursement Guide

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Plan Year 2026

Document ID: MH-CPG-2026-047 | Effective: January 1, 2026 | Version: 3.1

Licensed in: CT, NY, NJ, PA, MA, MD, VA, NC, GA, FL, OH, IL, MI, TX, CO, AZ, WA, OR, CA, MN, WI, IN

Overview of the Claim Process

MeridianHealth offers two pathways for claim settlement: cashless claims at in-network providers and reimbursement claims for out-of-network or non-participating provider services. For benefit amounts refer to the Plan Benefits Guide (MH-BRO-2026-047). For exclusions refer to the Claim Exclusion Reference (MH-EXC-2026-047). For definitions refer to the Terms and Conditions (MH-TC-2026-047, Section 1).

Cashless Claims at In-Network Providers

When a member receives care at an in-network provider, MeridianHealth settles the covered portion directly with the provider. The member pays only the applicable copayment, coinsurance, or deductible amount.

Planned (Non-Emergency) Cashless Claims

STEP 1 — Verify network status

Before scheduling, confirm network status at www.meridianhealth.example.com/find-a-provider or (800) 555-0199. Network status can change; verify within 30 days of the scheduled service.

STEP 2 — Obtain prior authorization

Certain services require prior authorization before being rendered. The PA list is at www.meridianhealth.example.com/prior-auth and includes: inpatient admissions (except emergency), outpatient surgery >\$2,500, advanced imaging (MRI, CT, PET), Tier 4 specialty medications, infertility treatments, bariatric surgery, residential treatment, and DME >\$1,000. Submit Form MH-PA-100 with clinical documentation. Response: 5 business days standard, 72 hours urgent.

STEP 3 — Present your MeridianHealth ID card

At the time of service, present your member ID card. It contains your member number, group number, plan tier, copayment amounts, and claims submission address.

STEP 4 — Pay your cost-sharing amount

Pay the applicable copayment at time of service. For coinsurance after deductible, the provider bills MeridianHealth first and sends you a statement for your share after processing.

STEP 5 — Review your EOB

After processing, MeridianHealth sends an Explanation of Benefits (EOB) detailing: total charges, allowable amount, MeridianHealth payment, deductible applied, and your responsibility. Available online within 7–10 business days. Dispute discrepancies within 60 days.

Emergency Cashless Claims

In an emergency, seek care at the nearest facility regardless of network status. Emergency services are covered at the in-network rate at any licensed facility per the No Surprises Act. Notify MeridianHealth within 48 hours of admission by calling (800) 555-0188. No balance billing for emergency services beyond the in-network allowed amount.

Reimbursement Claims (Out-of-Network)

When a member receives covered services from an out-of-network provider, the member pays directly and submits a reimbursement claim. Out-of-network services are subject to the OON deductible (2x in-network), 50% coinsurance, and the Maximum Allowable Amount (MAA). Amounts exceeding MAA are the member's responsibility and do not count toward the OOP maximum.

STEP 1 — Collect all documentation

Obtain itemized bills, receipts, and medical records. Ensure documents include: provider name, address, TIN; member name and DOB; date(s) of service; ICD-10 diagnosis codes; CPT/HCPCS procedure codes; itemized charges.

STEP 2 — Complete Form MH-RC-200

Download from www.meridianhealth.example.com/forms. Complete all sections: member info, provider info, diagnosis, treatment details, and whether related to accident/workers' comp/other insurance. Sign and date. Incomplete forms will be returned.

STEP 3 — Submit the claim

Mail to: MeridianHealth Claims Department, P.O. Box 5500, Hartford, CT 06102-5500. Or submit electronically via member portal or fax to (860) 555-0177. Retain copies of all documents.

STEP 4 — Claim processing and payment

Processing within 30 calendar days of complete submission. If additional info needed, notification within 15 calendar days. Payment via direct deposit or check. EOB details the reimbursement calculation.

Reimbursement Filing Deadline

Claims must be submitted within 90 calendar days of the date of service. Claims after 90 days but within 12 months accepted only if timely filing was not reasonably possible. Claims after 12 months will not be processed. Supplemental Shield: 60-day deadline, 6-month hard cutoff.

Required Documentation Checklist

Document	Cashless	Reimburse.	Supp. Shield
MeridianHealth Member ID Card	Required	Copy	Copy
Government-Issued Photo ID	At facility	Copy	Copy
Prior Authorization Approval	If applicable	If applicable	N/A
Claim Form (MH-RC-200 or MH-SS-300)	N/A	MH-RC-200	MH-SS-300
Itemized Hospital / Provider Bill	By provider	Original	Original
Discharge Summary	By provider	Original	Original
Prescription Receipts	By pharmacy	Original	Original
Diagnostic Reports (lab, imaging)	By provider	Copies OK	Copies OK
Attending Physician Certificate	N/A	Inpatient	All claims
Accident / Incident Report	N/A	If accident	If accident
Workers' Comp Denial Letter	N/A	If WC denied	N/A
Coordination of Benefits Statement	N/A	If dual coverage	If dual coverage

Appeals Process for Denied Claims

If a claim is denied, the member receives an Adverse Benefit Determination (ABD) notice with the reason, the plan provision basis, and appeal rights. Two levels are available per the Terms and Conditions (MH-TC-2026-047, Section 7).

Level 1 — Internal Appeal

File within 180 calendar days of the ABD notice. Submit Form MH-APL-400 with supporting documentation. Decision: 30 days (pre-service), 60 days (post-service), 72 hours (urgent). Reviewed by a qualified clinician not involved in the original determination.

Level 2 — External Review

If internal appeal denied, request external review within 4 months via state Dept. of Insurance or directly to MeridianHealth (forwarded to certified IRO). Conducted under 45 CFR Part 147. Binding on MeridianHealth. Decision: 45 days standard, 72 hours expedited. No cost to member.

Expedited Appeals

Available when standard timeframe could jeopardize life, health, or maximum function. Attending physician may request on member's behalf. Internal: 72 hours. Expedited external review may be requested simultaneously.

Reimbursement Calculation (Out-of-Network)

Step 1: Determine the Maximum Allowable Amount (MAA) = 150% of Medicare fee schedule rate for the same service in the same geographic area.

Step 2: Apply the out-of-network deductible (2x the in-network deductible for the member's tier). In-network and OON deductibles are tracked separately.

Step 3: Apply 50% OON coinsurance. MeridianHealth pays 50% of MAA remaining after deductible; member pays 50%.

Step 4: Any charges exceeding MAA = member responsibility (balance billing). Excess charges do NOT count toward deductible or OOP max.

Example: Silver 70 member, OON procedure billed at \$5,000. Medicare rate = \$2,000, so MAA = \$3,000. OON deductible = \$9,000 (2x \$4,500). Assuming deductible unmet: full \$3,000 MAA applies to deductible. Member pays \$3,000 (deductible) + \$2,000 (balance bill) = \$5,000. Only \$3,000 counts toward OON deductible and OOP max.

Supplemental Shield Claim Process

The Supplemental Shield plan pays fixed indemnity amounts directly to the policyholder, processed separately from the base medical plan. Benefits paid regardless of other insurance.

STEP 1

Complete Form MH-SS-300 (available at www.meridianhealth.example.com/forms).

STEP 2

Attach Attending Physician's Certificate confirming diagnosis, date of onset, and treatment dates.

STEP 3

Attach original itemized bills and discharge summary. For Critical Illness claims: pathology reports or diagnostic confirmation.

STEP 4

Submit within 60 calendar days of service/discharge. Late claims accepted within 6 months if timely filing was not reasonably possible.

STEP 5

Processing within 15 business days. Payment directly to policyholder by direct deposit or check.

Note: Supplemental Shield claims are subject to waiting periods in the Terms and Conditions (MH-TC-2026-047, Section 4.3). Claims for conditions within a waiting period will be denied. Member may appeal if the condition does not meet the pre-existing condition definition.

Contact Information

Department	Phone	Hours	Additional
Member Services	(800) 555-0199	Mon–Fri 8am–8pm ET	memberservices@meridianhealth.example.com
Claims Dept.	(800) 555-0177	Mon–Fri 8am–6pm ET	Fax: (860) 555-0177
Prior Authorization	(800) 555-0166	Mon–Fri 8am–6pm ET	Form MH-PA-100 online
24/7 Emergency Line	(800) 555-0188	24 hours / 7 days	Emergency admissions only
Appeals Dept.	(800) 555-0155	Mon–Fri 9am–5pm ET	Form MH-APL-400 online
Pharmacy Help Desk	(800) 555-0144	Mon–Fri 8am–8pm ET	Formulary and Rx questions

Always verify network status before non-emergency services. Keep copies of all submissions. Review every EOB for accuracy. File within required timelines: 90 days (medical), 60 days (Supplemental Shield).